

Partner Challenges

Selected Hacktoberfest Hack Day events may receive one additional partner prize category. The MLH Hacktoberfest team assigns the category and adds it to OrganizerHQ automatically; hosts do not need to create it.

Use the page for your assigned category to find the participant-facing challenge copy, resources, opening materials, winner guidance, and expected prize:

- [Google Gemma](#)
- [Snowflake](#)
- [Solana](#)
- [GitHub Copilot](#)

Your event onboarding remains the source of truth for its assigned category and prize details. If an assigned category is missing from OrganizerHQ, contact hacktoberfest@mlh.io ✉. Do not create a replacement, although you may still add your own local challenges.

Every Hack Day also runs the separate [Best Open-Source AI Project challenge](#).

Google Gemma

Challenge copy, participant resources, opening materials, and winner guidance for the Google Gemma category.

Last reviewed: August 2026

Google supports Major League Hacking and the Hack Days program with AI tools for experimentation and rapid prototyping. This category gives hackers a chance to build with Gemma, Google's family of lightweight, open models.

Best Use of Gemma 4

It's time to see how much you can build with a lightweight, open model. Gemma 4 packs multimodal intelligence into an open-weights model that you can access through the Gemini API. Gemma 4 can help you:

- Work with text and images to create an assistant that understands more of what users share
- Build a focused AI tool for learning, creativity, productivity, or your community
- Experiment with an open model while using the Gemini API to move quickly from an idea to a working prototype

Bring your idea to life... what will you build with Gemma 4 today?

Participant Resources

Share these resources before and during the event:

- [Gemma 4 resources](#) ↗
- [Gemma Quickstart](#) ↗
- [Gemma API docs](#) ↗
- [Gemma Beginner Guide](#) ↗

Opening Ceremony

Use the opening ceremony materials included in your event onboarding.

Choosing the Winner

Confirm that the winning project actually uses a Gemma model through the Gemini API. Ask the team to identify the model in its README and show the integration in its code or demonstration.

Expected Prize

Prizes vary by region and available inventory. Depending on the event, the winning team may receive an MLH+DEV branded swag bag, a mechanical keyboard, or a digital gift card. Swag bags may include a branded bag, notebook, and other items. Check your event's onboarding materials before sharing prize details with participants.

Snowflake

Challenge copy, participant resources, opening materials, and winner guidance for the Snowflake category.

Snowflake supports Major League Hacking with tools for building data and AI applications. Snowflake CoCo is its AI coding agent for data work, available on the web, desktop, and command line.

Best Open-Source AI Project with Snowflake

Use Snowflake CoCo to find or understand a freely accessible dataset in Snowflake, then build an open-source AI project around it.

- Explore the Snowflake Marketplace or Snowflake sample data with CoCo
- Use CoCo to understand the dataset, write queries, or create a data pipeline
- Build an AI application, agent, analysis, or other useful experience with open-source code

Eligible projects combine all three elements: CoCo, a freely accessible Snowflake dataset, and open-source or open-weight AI.

Participant Resources

Share these resources before and during the Fest:

- [Snowflake CoCo overview](#) ↗
- [Snowflake CoCo trial](#) ↗
- [Explore Snowflake Marketplace listings](#) ↗
- [Snowflake sample datasets](#) ↗

Opening Slides

Use the Hacktoberfest Snowflake opening slides included in your event onboarding. Make a copy and edit only the host-controlled slides.

Choosing the Winner

The project must use open-source or open-weight AI, use a freely accessible Snowflake dataset, and be published in a public GitHub repository with an open-source license. Ask the team to identify the dataset and show how CoCo helped them explore the data or build the project.

Expected Prize

Arduino Tiny Machine Learning Kit

Check your event's onboarding materials before sharing prize details with participants, as availability may vary by region.

Solana

Challenge copy, participant resources, opening materials, and winner guidance for the Solana category.

The Solana Agent Registry is an open, onchain protocol for giving AI agents verifiable identities, portable reputation, and validation records. It gives participants a practical way to explore how people and software can decide which agents to trust.

Best Use of the Solana Agent Registry

Build an open-source project that uses the Solana Agent Registry to give an AI agent a verifiable identity, make reputation easier to understand, or record useful validation data.

- Register an agent with a verifiable onchain identity
- Build a way to discover agents or understand their reputation and feedback
- Use validation records to help people or other agents make safer decisions

Participant Resources

Share these resources before and during the Fest:

- [Solana Agent Registry ↗](#)
- [Solana Hack Day resources ↗](#)
- [Solana documentation ↗](#)
- [Solana tutorials ↗](#)
- [Solana templates ↗](#)

Opening Slides

Use the Hacktoberfest Solana opening slides included in your event onboarding. Make a copy and edit only the host-controlled slides.

Choosing the Winner

Confirm that the winning project uses the Solana Agent Registry as an important part of the experience. Ask the team to show the relevant code and the registration, reputation, feedback, validation, or other onchain interaction during its demonstration. The project must be published in a public GitHub repository with an open-source license.

Expected Prize

[Ledger Nano S Plus](#) ↗

Check your event's onboarding materials before sharing prize details with participants, as availability may vary by region.

GitHub Copilot

Challenge copy, participant resources, opening materials, and winner guidance for the GitHub Copilot category.

GitHub Copilot acts as an AI pair programmer while participants plan, write, test, and document their projects.

Best Hack Built with GitHub Copilot

Build an open-source AI project with GitHub Copilot. This category focuses on how the team used Copilot during development.

- Describe what you need in natural language and use Copilot to create a starting point
- Explore an unfamiliar model, framework, API, or open-source codebase
- Generate boilerplate, tests, queries, or documentation so you can focus on the core experience

Publish the project in a public GitHub repository with an open-source license.

Explain in the README or demo where GitHub Copilot helped the team learn, solve a problem, test an implementation, or document the project.

Participant Resources

Students can get GitHub Copilot through the GitHub Student Developer Pack. Use mlh.link/GitHub ↗ for fast-tracked access. If student verification is still pending, participants can use the available free tier or trial.

Opening Slides

Use the [GitHub Copilot opening ceremony deck](#) ↗. Make a copy and edit only the host-controlled slides. Use the Hacktoberfest challenge copy on this page in place of the standard Hack Days category.

Choosing the Winner

Choose a working open-source AI project that demonstrates clear and useful use of GitHub Copilot. The public repository must include an open-source license, and the README or demo must give specific examples of how Copilot helped the team build it.

Expected Prize

Wireless Headphones

Check your event's onboarding materials before sharing prize details with participants, as availability may vary by region.